

Legacy & Next Step

This is the final session of the season. Players close with reflection on who they've become, what they contributed and which step they want to take.

 40 minutes

 Group + Individual

3 exercises

Evidence-based



What will you take with you today?

01

You reflect on your **growth as a person and teammate** over the whole season.

02

You formulate **three concrete, behaviour-focused intentions** for next season.

03

You close the season with a conscious sense of **meaning and contribution** to the team.

Henriksen et al. (2020) — review of 44 studies: season closings with explicit reflection on values and intentions increase identity development and long-term sport participation. *British Journal of Sports Medicine*.

Season-closing reflection on personal growth is associated with higher intrinsic motivation the following season.

Seligman (2011) — PERMA model: meaning and accomplishment are the two most underestimated components of wellbeing in adolescents.

5 Moments of Character

BEHAVIOUR & CHARACTER ONLY

Write five concrete moments of behaviour and character — not points or assists. What made the team stronger?

LOOK BACK AT MONTH 1

Bring the Month 1 worksheet (the Three Words). 'Are you still that person? Have you grown?'

Read aloud: read the Invisible Contributions (month 5), with names after permission. This is an emotional highlight of the programme.

Write one concrete behaviour intention for yourself and one for the team for next season.

Write one intention for the relationship with your coach. Make everything specific — not 'try harder' but concrete behaviour.

Use later: the intentions are input for your talks at the start of next season. 'You wrote you wanted to be the first voice more. How did that go?'

3

Letter to My Future Self

A letter to yourself of next season — kept and opened at the start of next season

What do you hope to have learned? What kind of teammate do you want to be? Write honestly — no one reads this but you.

The letters are folded and sealed. The coach keeps them and returns them at the first session next season.

Closing ceremony: each player says one thing they learned about themselves this season — not about basketball, about character.

Phil Jackson — 11x NBA Champion Coach, Chicago Bulls & LA Lakers

Tips for this session



Tip 1 — Write one too

Write a letter to your future self as coach too and share a piece. Close as you began: vulnerability as strength.



Tip 2 — Personal message

Send each player a personal observation of their growth — not a result, a moment of character. The most powerful feedback you can give.



Tip 3 — Continuity

Use the intentions as input for talks at the start of next season. Continuity makes the programme sustainable.



Careful: enough time

Give the closing session at least 45 minutes. This isn't an add-on but the highlight of 8 months of work.

40-minute session

Look back at Month 1 worksheets

Read aloud the Invisible Contributions

Fill in Month 8 worksheet individually

Seal and hand over the letters

Closing ceremony: one thing learned about character

⚡ TEAM RITUAL - THE COMPASS WORD

Each player chooses one value or word they want to live more next week and says it out loud in the circle. Start yourself. One word per player — the power is in the simplicity.

The programme is complete — but character keeps growing. Keep the letters and open them at the start of next season.